

JAR OF THOUGHTS

Complete Feature List

SHELF & HOME SCREEN

- Wooden illustrated shelf with two planks — upper plank holds jars, lower plank holds fire pit and archive box
- Wood grain texture lines on each shelf plank
- Warm ambient glow radiating from the fire pit area
- Responsive rack system — jars automatically reflow into rows based on screen width
- ResizeObserver watches container width and recomputes jars per row on every resize
- Minimum 2 empty racks always visible on the shelf
- Each rack is a full-width wooden shelf plank styled consistently
- Smooth Framer Motion layout animation when jars reflow into new positions
- Fire pit (🔥) fixed at bottom left of lower shelf — animated looping flames (3 SVG paths, staggered)
- Steel lockbox fixed at bottom right of lower shelf — lid opens and padlock disappears when archiving
- Fixed bottom bar (fire + archive) stays visible while shelf scrolls independently
- Ambient radial glow behind fire pit changes with theme
- Quick stats row below the header: jar count, thought count, locked capsules count (only shown if > 0)
- "New jar" button in the quick stats row
- Hint text: "tap · hold for options · double-tap to write"

JAR VISUALS

- Realistic illustrated glass jar SVG for every jar

- Proportional liquid fill – fill level rises as thought count increases (formula: $\min(0.82, \max(0.05, \text{count} \times 0.11))$)
- Liquid surface wave path at the top of the fill
- Glass transparency effect with left-side shine streak and small right shine
- Glass outline stroke
- Jar neck rectangle
- Wooden lid with knob that animates upward and rotates when jar is open
- Lid underside depth effect
- Drop shadow behind the jar body
- Elliptical bottom rim shadow
- Handwritten label on the glass body showing jar name in cursive font, slightly rotated (-1.5 degrees)
- Label has aged paper background with subtle border
- Emoji displayed below each jar
- Thought count badge (pill-shaped, coloured with jar colour) appears top-right of the jar when count > 0
- Jar lifts upward (-8px) and gains stronger drop shadow when selected/open
- Staggered entrance animation on mount (each jar fades in with a 60ms delay offset)

JAR INTERACTIONS

- Single tap → opens jar panel (bottom sheet with chits)
- Double tap → opens jar panel AND immediately opens write modal
- Long press on mobile (600ms hold) → opens jar options modal
- Right-click on desktop → opens jar options modal
- Pencil icon in open jar panel header → opens jar options modal

JAR MANAGEMENT

- Add custom jar: name input, emoji picker (20 emoji options), colour swatch picker (12 preset colours)
- Rename jar: editable name field in options modal, saves to localStorage
- Delete jar: confirmation step warning that all thoughts inside will be permanently deleted, removes jar and all its thoughts
- Jar options modal has three modes: menu → rename or delete → confirmation

WRITING A THOUGHT

- Write modal slides up from bottom as a bottom sheet
- Swipe-down handle at top of modal — drag down more than 60px to close
- Tap backdrop to close
- Shows which jar you are writing into (emoji + name label)
- Paper-textured textarea with faint ruled lines (repeating-linear-gradient)
- Auto-focus on textarea when modal opens
- Placeholder: "What's on your mind..."
- Textarea is free resize, minimum height 130px
- createdAt timestamp captured automatically as ISO 8601 at the moment of save — never entered by user
- Time capsule toggle (on/off switch)
- When time capsule is on: lock duration options — 1 month, 3 months, 6 months, 1 year
- Drop button disabled and greyed out when textarea is empty
- Drop button label shows destination jar emoji + name
- "Drop into jar ↓" animation on save

TIME CAPSULE

- Any thought can be locked until a future date
- Lock durations: 1 month, 3 months, 6 months, 1 year

- Locked thoughts appear in the jar panel as sealed entries showing only "🔒 Time capsule" and the unlock date
- Locked thoughts cannot be tapped or read until the unlock date passes
- On every app load, all locked thoughts are checked — any with `unlockAt ≤ now()` are automatically unlocked
- Locked capsule count shown in quick stats row on home screen
- Locked thoughts shown with dashed accent-coloured border and reduced opacity

READING THOUGHTS (JAR PANEL)

- Bottom sheet slides up when a jar is tapped
- Swipe-down handle — drag to close
- Close button in header
- "+ Write" button in header to add a new thought to this jar
- Pencil icon next to jar name to open jar options
- Thoughts sorted newest first
- Each chit shows: truncated thought text, creation date (short format)
- Locked chits show: "🔒 Time capsule" label + unlock date, greyed out, non-tappable
- Empty state message when jar has no thoughts
- Staggered entrance animation for chit list items

READING A CHIT (CHIT PAPER)

- Tapping a chit opens it as a draggable paper card in the centre of the screen
- Paper card has aged paper background with faint ruled lines
- Shows jar emoji + name as a label at the top
- Full thought text in readable size with line-height matching the ruled lines
- Creation date in long format (e.g. "June 19, 2026 · 10:37 PM")

- Blurred backdrop behind the paper card
- Tap backdrop to close
- Paper card is freely draggable across the screen (Framer Motion drag)
- When drag starts: 🔥 delete zone appears bottom-left, 📁 archive zone appears bottom-right as circular overlays with dashed borders and labels
- Drop zones animate in with scale + fade when dragging begins
- Drop zones disappear when drag ends without hitting a target
- Drag chit to fire zone → triggers burn animation → thought permanently deleted
- Drag chit to archive zone → steel box lid opens → thought moved to archive
- Burn overlay: full-screen dark overlay + giant 🔥 emoji that scales up then shrinks to nothing

SEARCH

- Accessible from search icon in top bar
- Minimum 2 characters to trigger search
- Searches thought text case-insensitively across all jars
- Excludes locked time capsule thoughts from results
- Results grouped by jar with colour dot and jar emoji + name
- Shows thought count per jar in section header
- Each result card shows: first 2 lines of thought, relative time ("3 months ago")
- Clear button (x) appears in search input when text is entered
- Empty state when query has < 2 characters
- No results state when query matches nothing
- Tapping a result navigates to the chit view for that thought
- Fully responsive with max-width centred layout
- Follows active theme and dark/light mode via useTheme hook

ARCHIVE

- Accessible from archive icon on lower shelf or via navigation
- Shows all archived thoughts in reverse chronological order
- Each card shows: jar tag with colour dot + emoji + name, full thought text, creation date + relative time
- Restore button: moves thought back to its original jar in jot_thoughts
- Delete button: permanently removes from archive (red bordered button)
- Empty state when archive is empty
- Staggered entrance animation for cards
- Thought count shown in page subtitle ("N thoughts stored")
- Fully responsive with max-width centred layout
- Follows active theme and dark/light mode

STATS / ANALYTICS

- Accessible from bar chart icon in top bar
- Summary cards (2x2 grid): total thoughts, jars on shelf, time capsules, most used jar
- Date range row: first thought date, latest thought date
- Donut chart: jar distribution with colour-coded segments and percentage labels (SVG, no library)
- Colour legend below donut showing each jar's name and percentage
- 6-month bar chart: writing activity per month using theme accent colour (CSS bars)
- At-a-glance 2x2 insight grid: active days (days with at least one thought), average words per thought, journey span (days from first to latest thought), locked time capsules count
- Export button: saves all jars/thoughts/archive/settings to JSON backup file
- Import button: restores full app state from a backup JSON file
- Fully responsive with max-width centred layout

- Follows active theme and dark/light mode

BACKUP & RESTORE

- Export: collects all localStorage data (jars, thoughts, archive, theme, dark mode preference) into a single JSON object with version number and export timestamp
- On browser: triggers file download
- On Android (Capacitor): opens native share sheet (can send to Drive, Gmail, Files, etc.)
- Import: user selects a JSON backup file, app validates version field, writes all data back to localStorage, reloads
- Backup file is human-readable JSON

THEME SYSTEM

- 5 named colour themes: Amber (warm brown), Sage (forest green), Rose (dusty rose), Slate (blue-grey), Lavender (purple)
- Each theme has a light variant and a dark variant — 10 total combinations
- 🎨 Palette icon in top bar opens theme picker modal
- Theme picker shows 5 circular swatches with current theme highlighted
- Swipe-down handle on theme picker to close
- Dark/light toggle button (🌙 moon / ☀️ sun) in top bar
- Theme and dark preference both saved to localStorage and persist across sessions
- All colours applied via inline style token objects — no CSS variables needed
- useTheme hook polls localStorage every 300ms so Stats/Search/Archive update live when theme changes on Home without page reload
- Smooth background colour transitions (0.3–0.4s) across all surfaces when switching

TYPOGRAPHY & FONTS

- Headings and jar names: Playfair Display (serif, Google Fonts)
- All UI text: Inter (sans-serif, Google Fonts)
- Handwritten jar labels: Caveat / Segoe Script / Bradley Hand (system cursive fallback chain)
- Google Fonts cached by service worker for offline use

PWA

- manifest.json with name, short_name, display: standalone, background_color, theme_color, icons
- Service worker via vite-plugin-pwa with Workbox CacheFirst strategy
- All static assets cached on first load — full offline functionality after that
- Auto-update service worker on new deployment
- Google Fonts runtime cached separately (CacheFirst, named cache)
- Installable via Chrome on Android: Add to Home Screen → custom icon, full-screen, no browser bar

ANDROID (CAPACITOR)

- Full native APK buildable via Capacitor + Android Studio
- Custom app icon set via Android Studio Image Asset tool
- Runs in native WebView — full-screen, no browser chrome
- Back button intercepted: navigates to Home from any screen, only exits app from Home
- Native Share API used for export (bypasses WebView blob download limitation)
- APK tested and installed on physical Android device

SHARED APP HEADER (AppHeader component)

- Shown on Home, Stats, Search, and Archive screens
- App title "Jar of Thoughts" in Playfair Display

- Tagline "your quiet corner"
- Search icon → navigates to Search screen
- Stats icon → navigates to Stats screen
- Palette icon → opens theme picker
- Dark/light toggle icon

GENERAL UX

- All bottom sheets have a drag handle and can be closed by swiping down (threshold: 60px)
- All modal backdrops close the modal on tap
- All primary buttons disabled and greyed when their required input is empty
- Thought count badges use the jar's own colour as background
- Every screen scrolls vertically only — no horizontal scroll except quick stats pill row
- No loading states needed — all operations are synchronous localStorage reads/writes
- All dates displayed in US long format for clarity (e.g. "June 19, 2026 · 10:37 PM")
- Relative dates shown alongside absolute dates ("Written 8 months ago")
- Empty states with helpful messages on every list screen

Jar of Thoughts

Full Project History

Phase 1 — Project Setup

- Chose tech stack: React + Vite + Tailwind CSS + Framer Motion + dayjs + localStorage
- Created Vite project with React + JavaScript template

- Installed all dependencies: react-router-dom, framer-motion, dayjs, lucide-react, vite-plugin-pwa
- Set up folder structure: hooks/, components/, screens/
- Configured vite.config.js with PWA plugin (vite-plugin-pwa + Workbox for offline support)
- Configured index.css with Tailwind v4 import and Google Fonts (Playfair Display + Inter)
- Updated index.html with PWA manifest link and theme-color meta tag
- Set up App.jsx with React Router v6 and all screen routes
- Initialised Git repository and pushed to GitHub

Phase 2 — Data Layer

- Built useJars.js hook: loads/saves jars to localStorage (key: jot_jars), pre-seeds 7 default jars on first load, exposes addJar and deleteJar
- Built useThoughts.js hook: loads/saves thoughts (jot_thoughts) and archive (jot_archive), exposes addThought, deleteThought, archiveThought, moveThought, unlockDueThoughts, restoreFromArchive, deleteFromArchive
- Default jars: Love ❤️, Life 🌿, Sadness ☁️, Neutral Thoughts ☹️, Dreams ✨, Gratitude 🌻, Unsent Words 🔥
- Thought data model: id (crypto.randomUUID), text, jarId, createdAt (auto ISO timestamp), isLocked, unlockAt

Phase 3 — Core Screens (first version)

- JarSVG.jsx: SVG glass jar with proportional liquid fill, lid that lifts when open, shine streaks, label area
- JarCard.jsx: animated card with jar SVG, name, emoji, thought count
- Home.jsx (v1): wooden shelf grid, 3-column jar layout, floating "+ New Thought" FAB
- Write.jsx: paper-textured textarea with ruled lines, jar picker pills, time capsule toggle (1m/3m/6m/1y/custom), auto-captures createdAt on save
- JarView.jsx: lists chits sorted newest first, locked chits shown as sealed, random chit button
- ChitView.jsx: paper card with unfolding animation, full thought + timestamp + relative date, delete/archive/move modals

- Stats.jsx (v1): total thoughts, jar count, most used jar, CSS bar chart per jar, first/latest dates
- Search.jsx (v1): keyword search across all unlocked thoughts, grouped by jar
- Archive.jsx (v1): archived thoughts with restore and permanent delete

Phase 4 — UI Redesign (immersive shelf)

- Replaced grid layout with physical wooden shelf aesthetic
- Two-plank shelf system: upper plank holds jars, lower plank holds fire pit and steel archive box
- JarSVG redesigned: realistic glass jar with gradients, liquid fill with wave surface, glass shine, wooden lid that animates open
- Home redesigned: dark warm background, animated fire pit (🔥 flames loop), steel lockbox with padlock animation
- ChitPaper component: draggable paper chit, drag to 🔥 to delete, drag to 📁 to archive, fire/archive zones appear as overlays when dragging starts
- WriteModal: slide-up sheet from bottom, paper-lined textarea, time capsule toggle, drop animation
- Swipe-down handle on all bottom panels to close by dragging

Phase 5 — Light Theme + Dark Toggle

- Default changed to light theme (warm cream #FDF6E3 background)
- Dark/light toggle button (🌙/☀️) in top bar, preference saved to localStorage (jot_dark)
- All panels, write modal, chit paper, textarea respond to dark/light mode

Phase 6 — Theme System (5 colour themes)

- 5 themes added: Amber (warm brown), Sage (forest green), Rose (dusty rose), Slate (cool blue-grey), Lavender (soft purple)
- Each theme has full light and dark variant (10 total combinations)
- 🎨 palette icon opens theme picker modal with colour swatches
- Theme saved to localStorage (jot_theme)
- useTheme.js shared hook created so Stats, Search, Archive all read theme from localStorage and update live

Phase 7 — Jar Management

- Add custom jar: name input, emoji picker (20 options), colour swatches (12 options)
- Rename jar: long-press on mobile, right-click on desktop, or pencil icon in open panel
- Delete jar: with confirmation warning that all thoughts inside will be deleted
- Jar options modal with menu → rename / delete / cancel flow
- Handwritten label on each jar showing jar name in cursive font, slightly rotated

Phase 8 — Responsive Shelf Rack System

- Replaced fixed grid with dynamic rack system using ResizeObserver
- JAR_CELL = 80px, jars per row computed from container width automatically
- All jars (default + custom) participate in same layout pool
- Jars reflow into rows on load, resize, and when new jars are added
- Each row rendered as a styled wooden shelf plank with wood grain lines
- At least 2 empty shelves displayed always
- Fire pit + steel box fixed at bottom, independent of scrollable shelf area
- Shelf area scrollable, bottom bar stays visible
- Smooth Framer Motion layout animations on reflow

Phase 9 — Stats Page Enhancements (your changes)

- Donut chart: shows jar mix with colour-coded legend and percentages, CSS/SVG only
- 6-month bar chart: writing activity per month using theme accent colour
- At-a-glance 2x2 grid: active days, average words per thought, journey span (days), locked time capsules

Phase 10 — Shared App Header

- AppHeader component extracted: title + search/stats/palette/dark-mode icons

- AppHeader now shown on Archive, Stats, and Search pages (not just Home)

Phase 11 — Backup & Restore

- Export button on Stats page: saves all jars/thoughts/archive/settings to a JSON file
- On Android (Capacitor): uses native Share sheet to send to Drive/Gmail/etc
- On browser: standard file download
- Import button: restore full app state from exported file

Phase 12 — Android / PWA

- PWA manifest.json: name, short_name, display standalone, theme_color #B5804A, icons 192x192 and 512x512
- Service worker via vite-plugin-pwa: CacheFirst strategy, full offline support
- Capacitor installed and configured for Android
- APK built and installed on phone multiple times via Android Studio
- Custom app icon set via Android Studio Image Asset tool using icon-512.png
- Fixed Android back button: pressing back from Archive/Search/Stats navigates to Home instead of exiting app
- Debugged slow Gradle sync (caused by OneDrive + Windows Defender disk conflict)
- Fixed export bug: WebView doesn't support blob download trick → switched to Capacitor native Share sheet
- Cleared stale service worker cache after fix, confirmed export works

Phase 13 — Firebase (paused, not applied)

- Firebase project created
- Firestore + email/password Auth enabled in Firebase console
- Login screen written
- Firestore-backed hooks written
- Paused before integrating into the actual app — ready to resume whenever cloud sync is needed